BCBS AR Case Manager FAQ

BCBS AR · Common questions from the field

Can I share the provider's phone number with a member?

Yes — once the referral reaches Accepted By Provider status. The phone number is visible in Benefits Hub before that, but it isn't ready to hand out until the provider accepts.

A member's authorization shows Remaining as 0.00, but I thought they still had hours left. What happened?

Remaining is calculated as Plan Allowance minus Used minus Pending. Pending hours count against the balance even before they're finalized, so Remaining can hit zero before a member has actually received all their care.

A member only needs one of the two services. Is that a problem?

No — not every member uses both Post-Discharge and Virtual Companion. It's completely normal for a member to have only one service referral, or none at all if a case manager hasn't created one yet.

What is the Initial IHS Assessment tile?

It's a separate one-point benefit for the member's initial in-home assessment, with its own authorization. It doesn't use any of the member's 20 post-discharge hours.

Do I need to create the assessment referral?

No. Create your referrals from the Post Discharge Support tile only. You may see Add Referral on the assessment tile too, but leave it alone — the Helper Bees team creates the assessment referral and assigns the provider once your post-discharge referral comes in.

The assessment tile shows Remaining 0.00. Is something wrong?

No. The assessment is a single point, and it's used once the assessment is completed — so zero remaining is the normal end state.

Is assessment visit documentation required?

No. Providers are prompted to upload it to the assessment referral if applicable, but it's optional, and not every assessment will have any — that isn't a problem. To see what the provider recorded at the visit, open the assessment encounter and read its Service Tasks.

How many hours should I enter for a Post Discharge referral?

Submit the full 20-hour referral. The 20 hours are one shared allotment: if the member will use both Post-Discharge and Virtual Companion, create a separate referral for each service and split the 20 hours between them. It's not 20 hours on each referral. Providers schedule Post-Discharge visits of no less than 2 hours, so the member won't be scheduled for anything shorter.

A member was discharged again. Do they get another 20 hours?

No. Members get one 20-hour allotment per benefit year, and another discharge in the same year doesn't create another allotment.

How long does a member have to use their post-discharge benefit?

The benefit is tied to one discharge event, and the member has six months to use it.

What if the member needs services at a different address than what's on file?

Use Change Service Address on the Add Referral screen, next to “Available Services for…”, to enter where care will happen. It applies to that referral only — the member's address on file doesn't change — and only one alternative address is allowed per checkout. Verify it again on the Referrals Summary before you check out. If it's wrong there, go back to the previous screen and change it: once you check out it can't be edited, and fixing it takes a Zendesk ticket (not guaranteed) or closing the referral and creating a new one.

A member calls their benefit their “Walmart benefit.” What do I do?

Recognize the reference — some members know this program informally that way — but keep your documentation and Benefits Hub entries in the approved formal program language.

Where do I find the phone number and quantity confirmation a case manager entered on a referral?

Select View → View SDQ on the referral row. The Service Detail Questions modal shows the best phone number on file and the quantity-allotted confirmation.

Why don't I see an encounter on a brand-new referral?

Encounters only appear after the provider has actioned the referral. A referral with no encounters yet isn't necessarily a problem — it just means the provider hasn't logged a visit.

Do I need to submit a separate escalation or grievance form?

No. BCBS AR routes every issue — from routine questions to stuck referrals — through the one Submit a Request form at bcbsar-thb.zendesk.com. Choose the Issue Type that best fits and include full details in Additional Comments. If a ticket is urgent, also email your THB Account Coordinator with the ticket number.

What if a required ticket field doesn't apply to my situation?

Enter N/A rather than leaving it blank. Every field marked with an asterisk is required, and an empty required field can stall the ticket.

I'm searching by ID and getting no results. Now what?

Use Advanced Search to look the member up by First Name, Last Name, and Date of Birth instead. Also double check you're using the care recipient's own ID, not the employee's, if they're a dependent.